WILLIAM TERRY, PhD

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Quantitative analyst and applied economist with 20+ years of experience designing and implementing data pipelines, statistical models, and reporting systems for government and policy clients. Expert in microsimulation modeling, causal inference, Bayesian and frequentist statistics, and BI reporting. Proven ability to integrate large, complex administrative datasets, automate reproducible analytic workflows, and translate technical findings for executive and legislative audiences. Actively incorporates AI-assisted tools into analytical workflows to accelerate data exploration, documentation, and research synthesis — with strong judgment about where human expertise remains essential. PhD in Political Science with a statistical methodology focus (UCSD); NSF Dissertation Award; postdoctoral fellowship at Princeton.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Tools: R, Stata, Excel; working knowledge of Python (pandas, scikit-learn), SQL, PySpark, and Databricks

Visualization & BI: Tableau, Power BI

Statistical Methods: Frequentist & Bayesian regression, causal inference (parametric & non-parametric), program evaluation, microsimulation, machine learning (supervised & unsupervised), multidimensional scaling, time-series analysis, Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA)

ERP & Data Systems: SAP (financial & fund accounting modules)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The Two-Front War: Democratization and Its Consequences in the Post-VRA South 2026

Book Manuscript — Under Contract, University of Pennsylvania Press

- Completed full-time revision of contracted academic monograph for submission to Penn Press, September 2026. The book analyzes the fiscal and political consequences of the Voting Rights Act of 1965 in the American South using original datasets, Bayesian item response theory and multidimensional scaling, supervised and unsupervised machine learning, structural topic models, and panel regression methods.

Commissioner (Volunteer) — Tax Supervision & Conservation Commission, Portland, OR 2025–2026

- Appointed by Governor Kotek to review and certify budget compliance for Multnomah County's independent taxing governments; applies quantitative analysis to assess fiscal sustainability across the County, City of Portland, PPS, TriMet, Metro, and dozens of others.

Senior Economist & Project Director — ECOnorthwest, Portland, OR 2025–2026

- Built microsimulation model in R forecasting tax revenue for Multnomah County's Preschool for All (PFA) program using Oregon Department of Revenue tax return microdata; model integrated data across multiple administrative sources with full reproducibility documentation.
- Supported Oregon's Universal Health Governance Board in constructing a tax revenue plan for a statewide single-payer healthcare system (Medicaid + Medicare populations) — requiring integration of administrative health and tax datasets and translation of methodological assumptions for a legislative audience.
- Directed economic impact study for Portland General Electric quantifying contributions to the Oregon economy.

Financial Analyst III — Portland Bureau of Transportation, Portland, OR 2023–2025

- Developed and maintained five- and ten-year financial forecasts and dynamic models for PBOT's ~$150M operating budget; built models updatable under changing assumptions to support real-time scenario analysis.
- Automated monthly budget-to-actual variance reporting pipeline: exported from SAP financial modules, transformed data, and delivered dashboards in Tableau and Power BI to bureau leadership and cost center managers.

- Conducted complex rate, fee, and debt financing analyses across PBOT's $500M operation; coordinated revenue bond issuance and post-issuance compliance monitoring.
- Supervised a Financial Analyst III; provided coaching, mentoring, and performance appraisals.

Research Manager — Prenatal-to-Three Policy Impact Center, Vanderbilt University, Nashville, TN 2020–2023

- Led in-house statistical research in R, Stata, and SQL; served as primary methodological resource for parametric and non-parametric causal inference and program evaluation for government clients.
- Directed construction of a state-level time-series cross-sectional dataset on child poverty and statutory policy parameters, including data validation, quality control, and documentation protocols.

Assistant Professor, Political Science — University of Oregon, Eugene, OR 2010–2019

- Published peer-reviewed research in State Politics & Policy Quarterly, Legislative Studies Quarterly, Latin American Research Review, and Politics, Groups, and Identities, using time-series cross-sectional, count, survival, and logit models on original fiscal, legislative, and municipal datasets.
- Taught PhD and undergraduate courses in statistics, research design, and quantitative methods; supervised PhD students in dissertation research.
- NSF-funded dissertation used Congressional roll call votes and floor speeches to evaluate fiscal implications of the Voting Rights Act.

Postdoctoral Fellow — Department of Politics, Princeton University, Princeton, NJ 2009–2010

- Developed the research that became *The Two-Front War* and a time-series cross-sectional analysis of lynching rates in the American South.

Research Associate — California Institute of Technology, Pasadena, CA 2004–2005

- Conducted statistical analysis in R of matriculation and outcomes data for women and underrepresented groups; presented findings and fielded technical questions for committee of senior faculty and Institute executives.

Analyst, Tax Analysis Division — U.S. Congressional Budget Office, Washington, DC 1999–2001

- Primary analyst for the federal EITC; maintained microsimulation code producing outlay estimates under current law and alternative scenarios using restricted-use IRS, Census, and SSA administrative microdata.
- Communicated technical findings and uncertainty to Congressional staff and policy audiences.

CIVIC & VOLUNTEER ROLES

Director & Board Secretary — The Emerson School (K–5 PPS Charter), Portland, OR 2023–2025

- Member of the governing body legally responsible for the financial well-being of the school; direct involvement in budget formulation, variance oversight, and fiduciary compliance as a non-profit corporation.

Member, Budget Advisory Committee — Portland Police Bureau, Portland, OR 2023–2025

EDUCATION & FELLOWSHIPS

PhD, Political Science (Statistical Methodology focus) — University of California, San Diego 2010

NSF Doctoral Dissertation Award

MS, Mathematical Economics — California Institute of Technology 2004

BA, Economics & Mathematics — Washington University in St. Louis (*Magna cum laude*) 2002

Morgan Stanley Richard B. Fisher Scholarship

SELECTED FELLOWSHIPS

Visiting Fellow, Centre for Peace & Development — KU Leuven, Belgium 2013

Associate Fellow, Centre for the Study of Civil War — PRIO, Oslo 2005–2006